

JAZZ TOOLBOX SAFETY

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #102

There is the great analogy of a jazz musician needing their toolbox. The place where they collect and keep their tools - their jazz licks, their good melodies, their rhythmic ideas, their harmonic substitutions. All jazz musicians need a toolbox, and usually the more tools we own, and the better we know how to use them, the better improviser we are.

Here's the thing. Tools are dangerous, and it's easy to cut off a finger, knock out a tooth, or stab yourself in the leg. You have to use your tools SAFELY. So too with your jazz toolbox. You can damage yourself (and your audience's ears) pretty badly if you aren't respecting your tools. Rule #1 For Jazz Tools - use one tool at a time, and pay attention to it. Using two tools at once is dangerous, especially when you are just starting out.

#1 - "A" section of Bernie's Tune

Blues Scale

Chord Tones

The first staff shows the Blues Scale for the first measure, with a Dm^7 chord above it. The second staff shows the Chord Tones for the first measure, with an $E\emptyset^7$ chord above it. The third staff shows the Chord Tones for the second measure, with an $A7(b9)$ chord above it. The fourth staff shows the Chord Tones for the third measure, with a Dm chord above it.

#2 - "A" section of Bernie's Tune

Chord Tones

Blues Scale

The fifth staff shows the Chord Tones for the first measure, with a Dm^7 chord above it. The sixth staff shows the Chord Tones for the second measure, with a Bb^7 chord above it. The seventh staff shows the Chord Tones for the third measure, with an $E\emptyset^7$ chord above it. The eighth staff shows the Chord Tones for the fourth measure, with an $A7(b9)$ chord above it. The ninth staff shows the Chord Tones for the fifth measure, with a Dm chord above it.